Y2021 PROMOTION EXAMINATION FOR PRINCIPAL MANAGERS

TEST TYPE: PLANNING, STRATEGY AND LEADERSHIP
SITUATIONAL JUDGEMENT TEST

In this test you will be asked to imagine yourself in a number of different scenarios and roles. You will be presented with situations and asked to select the response you believe you would be 'most' and 'least' likely to make to these situations from a range of options. It is recommended you read all the possible responses before deciding how to respond.

ANSWER ALL QUESTIONS
DURATION: 1 HOUR

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Points: 14/20

1. What is your full name *

[redacted]

Scenario 1

You are a Manager on a two-year training programme at the Benign Sunshine Agency. Benign Sunshine is the UK's fifth largest marketing agency and deals with all aspects of clients' marketing, market research, PR and advertising needs.

You are a 'floating' Manager and as such you are assigned to projects and to teams when they are likely to have a role for you and when they will have time to brief, coach and train you effectively in their work area. You also have a dedicated mentor to whom you can go at any time for help and support with regard to your progress, learning and work in the company.

2. You have joined a team which is preparing to pitch to an existing client to win a contract to provide the PR for a new range of children's books which aim to teach children about environmental issues in an interesting, engaging and fun way. The client is hoping that primary schools will be interested in purchasing the series of books as one of the major topics in the national curriculum at Key Stage 2 is environmental and energy awareness.

   The pitch team manager has asked you to take an active role in the pitch presentation to the client representatives. He particularly wants you to talk about your response to, and enjoyment of, the books as you are the youngest member of the team. The pitch is in two days' time.

   Review the following responses A to D and indicate which one you believe to be the response to the situation.

   Responses:
   (1/1 Points)

   A. Prepare a presentation based on a detailed analysis of previous children's books on this topic that have done well and how they were promoted.

   B. Prepare a presentation based on your experiences of learning about the environment as a child and your favourite books on the topic.

   C. Prepare a presentation about how you felt and what questions came into your mind when you read the clients' books. ✓

   D. Read the books to your nieces and nephews and prepare a presentation based on their response to the books.

3. You have three days to go until the end of a project that you have been working on for the last four weeks in the market research team. By now you would usually have an email or call from your mentor letting you know about your next assignment location or your host team would have asked you to stay on for more time if they required you. However, neither of these things have happened and therefore you are unsure where you are going to be working next week or what your responsibilities will be.

   Review the following responses A to D and indicate which one you believe to be the response to the situation.

   Responses:
   (1/1 Points)

   A. Delay the end of this project for as long as you can.

   B. Ask your current team leader if she can assign some additional tasks to you to continue this placement a little longer.

   C. Do nothing, as you will be able to use the 'downtime' after this project ends to pursue some personal development without having to work on a project for a while.

   D. Email your mentor to remind him that you think you are due to move onto a new posting or project in 3 days' time. ✓

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4. You have been asked to stay with the market research team for another project. Because of the competence you demonstrated on your last project in the team you have been given overall responsibility for a small piece of market research which Benign Sunshine have been commissioned to do by West Grimsdale Fire & Rescue Service (WGFRS).

   The Service wish to find out how many households in their region currently have smoke alarms fitted and are operational and, of those who don't, how many are willing to fit smoke alarms in the next 6 months either with or without incentives.

   Review the following responses A to D and indicate which one you believe to be the response to the situation.

   Responses:
   (0/1 Points)

   A. Write a script for a telephone interview which your researchers will conduct with a sample of West Grimsdale households.

   B. Find out how many households there are in West Grimsdale and into what social categories they fall.

   C. Book some telephone researchers for three days next week to call households in West Grimsdale.

   D. Ask your team leader if you can have a meeting with the key contact at WGFRS in order to gain clarification on the detailed objectives of the research. ✓

5. Over the last few weeks you have had sole responsibility for a market research project being conducted by Benign Sunshine on behalf of West Grimsdale Fire & Rescue Service (WGFRS). You have been doing your best to run the project according to the client's requirements but the key contact at WGFRS, Hector Jones, Director of Community Safety, has been a difficult person to work with.

   This morning you received an email from Mr Jones stating that he is unhappy with the number and the quality of interviews you have conducted in households in the region and that he will go "over your head" unless things improve immediately with regard to the running of the project. You believe that Mr Jones has been a little disappointed, and felt undervalued, because Benign Sunshine have put a trainee manager in charge of his project. This appears to have negatively affected his view all the way through the process.
   Review the following responses A to D and indicate which one you believe to be the response to the situation.

   Responses:
   (1/1 Points)

   A. Call Mr Jones immediately and apologise that he is unhappy. Ask exactly how you can improve the delivery of the project. ✓

   B. Email back and say that you have delivered all aspects of the project as agreed and attach a copy of the original project plan as proof.

   C. Call Mr Jones' diary secretary and ask for a face-to-face meeting to be booked in to clear up the issues raised.

   D. Inform your team leader that Mr Jones is being difficult and over critical so she won't be surprised if she hears from him later.

Scenario 2

You are working as an interim manager for a production company that specialises in TV history and art documentaries. Your role is to support the staff at the company and learn aspects of the work they do in order to enhance your production skills and eventually apply for a job as a production assistant. The company is called Knowledgematic. It is a small organisation with two company Directors, four full-time production assistants and one administrator. Specialist Producers and TV Directors are hired on a freelance basis to work on specific projects.

You have been at Knowledgematic for three months and have yet to gain any experience in location

filming. All your work has been studio-based and you are very keen to help out on a location shoot as this will enhance your CV for when you begin applying for permanent jobs.

6. You are aware the company is going to start filming a documentary about the Battle of Zaria next week and the first few weeks of the filming are going to be on location in Kaduna. You are very keen to be assigned to this project. However, George Folarin, one of the company directors has just approached you to ask that you take on a project to sort through and archive the video tapes, DVDs and film footage which is stored in the backroom at the Knowledgematic offices. He says that he thinks it could take a couple of weeks to go through everything, decide on what should be kept and then archive it properly. He would like you to start next week.

   Review the following responses A to D and indicate which one you believe to be the response to the situation.

   Responses:
   (1/1 Points)

   A. Be honest with George about your wishes and why you feel that it is important to you that you gain some experience on location. Ask him for his view on this and ask him whether there is any chance that you can spend some time on the Kaduna shoot before returning to the office to start your archiving project.

   B. Say you'd rather go to the location shoot in Kaduna as it would support your development more than doing the archiving.

   C. Agree to do the archiving project and ask George for a chance today to talk about your learning and development, specifically when you might get to do some location filming. ✓

   D. Agree to do the archiving project, hopefully another chance to experience location filming will arise soon.

7. It is a Monday morning; you have a busy week planned, with a media networking event tonight and a champagne preview screening of the Battle of Hastings documentary on Wednesday night. Greta Fornelli, one of the directors, has just approached you to say that she would like you to get involved in a location shoot for a Knowledgematic documentary on 'The Benin Kingdom'. The documentary is due to start filming in 3 days' time and requires three Benin streets in which to film. Three streets had been located and permission granted for filming. However, they have just found out that there are to be some major gas mains works being undertaken on one of the chosen streets during the time that the filming is due to take place.

   Greta has tasked you with finding an alternative street in which to film in time for the first day of filming on Thursday. The requirements for the location are that the street consist of all ancient or older houses, the street be in central Benin, that the street furniture (i.e. lamps etc) are either of the relevant period or unobtrusive, that residents and the local government council will give permission for filming and that the street is not one that has a busy through-flow of traffic; a cul-de-sac would be ideal. Greta says that the last time the location scout was given this brief it took her a week to locate the 3 streets needed.

   Review the following responses A to D and indicate which one you believe to be the response to the situation.

   Responses:
   (1/1 Points)

   A. Cancel your attendance at the champagne preview event as you can always view the Battle of Zaria documentary another day in the office when you have more time.

   B. Cancel your attendance at the media networking event tonight.

   C. Call the relevant people and apologise that you won't be able to attend the evening events and they should give your place to anyone who may be waiting for a ticket. ✓

   D. Tell Greta that you have two evening events planned before Thursday and that given the likely time it will take to find a relevant location perhaps she should assign another person to work alongside you on the task as well.

8. . Knowledgematic have been given an open brief by Channel 5 to deliver a new art documentary strand to appeal to young people aged between 14 and 25 and which will be aired on weeknights at 7.30pm. Steve Grade, one of the Knowledgematic directors, has given you the task of recommending the topic that should be the opening programme in the series. You must choose the one that will have maximum appeal and draw the target viewers in.

You have to choose between 3 programmes that are currently in production but will all be completed in time for the series opener in a few weeks' time. The programmes are:

- All You Ever Wanted To Know About Graphic Novels But Were Afraid To Ask (A detailed look at the life and work of three of the most successful graphic novelists working today, including the creator of a series of novels that have been turned into a Hollywood blockbuster trilogy.)
- Graffiti and Street Art: A Modern Rebellion (Going undercover with Africa's secretive and passionate graffiti artists and revealing the true identity of Bintsy the most famous and highly-valued street artist in the world.)
- The Festival Season (Following an outdoor performance artist, Taylor Hip, working the Africa and Asia's summer festivals; joining her as she hangs out with bands, comedians and other performers to share views on art, drugs, wellies and all manner of 'festivally' things.)

Review the following responses A to D and indicate which one you believe to be the response to the situation.

Responses:
(1/1 Points)

A. Research the popularity of the three topics on the internet; looking at 'trending' topics on Twitter, fan sites and other information.

B. Give your recommendation based on which one most appeals to you as you are not that knowledgeable about art and therefore feel that you are an average viewer in that sense.

C. Do an online survey of people aged 14 to 25 and ask them which of the titles most appeals to them; recommend the title that is given the most votes. ✓

D. Look at the viewing figures for previous documentaries on terrestrial TV which had similar topics.

9. You are helping out on a studio shoot for the documentary entitled 'The Benin Kingdom'. The presenter of the documentary, Professor Edwin Clark has come in to be filmed speaking about and looking at artefacts from ancient Benin, presenting them to camera and explaining their uses and manufacture.

Filming is due to commence in 15 minutes or so and you are just helping the Professor go through his lines and where he needs to move to as he holds certain objects and as he explains certain things. The idea is that video clips of actors demonstrating the objects in use will be superimposed behind the Professor eventually and therefore he needs to be correctly positioned so that his image allows space for the footage to fit behind or beside him.
Professor Clark has never done anything like this before and you notice that he is very nervous, his hands are shaking and his voice is trembling whilst you rehearse with him. He suddenly turns to you and says "I just don't think I can do this; you're going to need to get someone else".

Responses
(1/1 Points)

A. Tell the Professor that everyone gets nervous before filming and that you worked with a famous actor the other day who was suffering from performance anxiety just filming a 30 second trailer.

B. Get the Professor a cup of tea and let him sit down for a minute or two to collect himself.

C. Suggest that the Professor to take deep breaths, relax his shoulders and imagine that he is in his lecture room back at University, not in a studio at all. ✓

D. Tell the Professor that you're sure he'll be fine and not to worry.

Scenario 3

You are a manager in a branch of an independent coffee shop called Tradewinds. You have worked in the shop for 3 months. Tradewinds try to use customer experience to distinguish themselves from larger coffee chains.
Your main responsibilities are as follows:
•Serving food and beverages at the counter, in a helpful and pleasant manner, including making freshly-brewed espresso, latte and cappuccino coffees on demand.
•Ensuring all stock is within its "use by" or "best before" date, and rotated on a first in – first out basis.
•Checking deliveries for discrepancies, quality and temperature in accordance with the food safety guidelines.

•Operating the cash register, taking money and dealing with credit card transactions. Completing all paperwork relating to food safety and stock taking requirements.
•Cleaning and preparing the work surfaces, tables and chairs as required throughout the day.

You work either an early (8am to 4pm) or late (12pm to 8pm) shift, 6 days a week. One assistant usually works the late shift and two work the early shift. The Branch Manager is usually in the shop from 10am to 6pm.

10. It is 12.30pm on a Friday. A customer has come into the shop and has been browsing the food counter for a few minutes looking rather impatient and dissatisfied. When you asked the customer how you might be able to help them they said that they are unable to eat wheat or dairy and are finding your selection of food limiting as it is mostly sandwiches and the one salad on offer is a cheese salad. They have also asked to purchase a soya latte coffee. Your shop does not offer soya milk as an alternative to cow's milk as there has not been a great demand for it in the past.

    Review the following responses A to D and indicate which one you believe to be the response to the situation.

    Responses:
    (1/1 Points)

    A. Apologise to the customer and say that unfortunately there is not much on Tradewinds' menu which will be appropriate for their diet but they could try the healthfood cafe on the High Street.

    B. Say that your colleague would be happy to freshly prepare a salad without any cheese and ask if the customer would be happy to wait for a few moments whilst you find out about the soy latte. Ask your manager if you can pop out to the nearby convenience store for some soya milk to make the latte. ✓

    C. Apologise for the lack of soya milk but offer to freshly prepare a salad without any dairy in it for the customer. Point out any other items in the shop that would be appropriate for their diet.

    D. Suggest the customer go to the healthfood cafe on the High Street and, when the customer has gone, suggest to your manager that your branch introduce soya milk as an alternative for customers and make some non-dairy salads for vegans and people with restricted diets.

11. A new assistant called Danielle started work at the shop last week. You have worked three early shifts with her this week and two lunchtimes and during these hours she has appeared reluctant to help out with all the duties that are required of her. She is competent and keen with the paperwork and checking off the food deliveries. However she is not taking her fair share of the work when it comes to serving customers and seems to rely on you or other colleagues to take orders and take customers' money whenever possible. You are due to work an early shift with her again today.

Review the following responses A to D and indicate which one you believe to be the response to the situation.

Responses:
(1/1 Points)

A. Say nothing, but try to hang back every now and then when customers come into the shop, giving Danielle the opportunity to serve a customer on her own.

B. Take the opportunity to talk to Danielle when there is a lull in service this morning. Ask if she is feeling OK about all aspects of the job and whether she would like you to review any processes or tasks with her to remind her what to do. Say that serving customers is probably the most important aspect of the job and it can also be the most rewarding as you get to meet and talk to all sorts of different people. ✓

C. Say to Danielle that you feel that the responsibility for serving customers is hers as well as yours. State that you don't think it's fair that you continue dealing with the vast majority of customers whilst she only does the paperwork and deliveries behind the scenes.

D. When there is a chance this morning ask Danielle if she would like to observe you serving a customer. Show her how enjoyable it can be to serve customers by chatting and being friendly to customers and letting her see how they respond.

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12. You have asked your manager if you can work the late shift every day this week as you have to go to a class every morning in order to complete your food hygiene certificate. The shop closes at 7.30pm each day and the final half-hour of the shift is allocated to cashing up (counting the money, recording the amount and putting it in the safe overnight) and cleaning the kitchen area and shop in readiness for the following day. You have learnt on your course that the method of cleaning the kitchen surfaces at Tradewinds is not 'best practice' and to do it properly would add another 10 minutes on to the process.

Review the following responses A to D and indicate which one you believe to be the response to the situation.

Responses:
(0/1 Points)

A. Start cashing up at 7.20pm in order to make sure that you have the full half-hour to spend on the cleaning.

B. Talk to your manager and ask for an extra 10 minutes pay on the late shift so you can work until 8.10pm and finish the cleaning to the required standards.

C. Work as fast as you can to complete the cleaning to the required standard and quickly do the cashing up.

D. Commence the cleaning and cashing up as usual at 7.30pm but tackle the jobs in a reasonable order of priority. You could leave the least hygiene-critical parts of the shop until last, for example the chairs, tables and floor in the customer area. As long as you have wiped these down you could leave a note for the morning shift saying that they need to give the area a more thorough clean first thing in the morning. ✓

13. . It is Saturday lunchtime, the busiest time of the week for your Tradewinds branch. You are located on a busy shopping street and on Saturday many families and couples come in to get a quick sandwich and a hot drink when browsing the high street stores. This Saturday is no exception and you and your two colleagues are busy serving a queue of 8 customers.
Your colleague is serving the first customer and they are nearly finished paying. You have asked the second customer what they would like. However the third customer in the queue is a pregnant woman who is looking rather pale and is leaning heavily on the counter. The customer behind her is an impatient looking young man in business dress.

Review the following responses A to D and indicate which one you believe to be the response to the situation.

Responses:
(1/1 Points)

A. Ask the customer you are serving to excuse you for a minute. Turn to the pregnant woman and ask her if she is alright and whether she needs to sit down. If she says she does need to sit down then say that you or your colleague will come and take her order at her table so that she needn't stand any longer. Ask the young man behind her whether he is just buying cold food and drinks, in which case your colleague can serve him quickly after the second customer. ✓

B. Finish serving your current customer as quickly as possible in order that the pregnant woman and impatient man don't have to wait too long.

C. Tell the pregnant woman to take a seat at a table and your colleague or yourself will come and take her order soon.

D. Ask your colleague to keep serving at the till and go along the line of customers asking each one what their requirements are with regard to hot or cold food and drinks. Ask all those who only require cold food or drink to form a separate queue and serve these people quickly. Ask the other people to take a seat and wait for you to come and serve them in a minute.

Scenario 4

You are working as a Graduate Management Trainee for Lokogoma City Council (LCC).
Lokogoma is a medium-sized city located approximately 60 miles from Abuja on the northern axis. Its primary industries are tourism, financial services and call centres. It used to have a thriving commercial

and ferry port although this has reduced in size recently with some of the space being reallocated to retail outlets, leisure and water- side recreation.
The graduate training programme lasts for 3 years with 20% of your time is spent doing coursework and study for an MSc in Public Service Management at Abuja University. This works out at approximately 1 day a week at University. The remainder of your time you are assigned on a project-by-project basis to work for various departments and functions in the Council. The projects range in duration from 1 to 9 months. When each project is complete you, your project manager and your graduate mentor complete an assessment of your performance, learning and development needs based on your work on the project.

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14. You are currently working on a project to plan the decorative planting schemes around the city for next year. These planting schemes use seasonal bedding plants, mixed borders and bulb schemes to create colour and interest throughout the year on the city's roadside verges, road islands and central reservations of major roads. Your team have just completed the outline plan for next year but have now heard that, due to Central Government budget cuts, Lokogoma has decided to reduce the budget for your project by 50%. You are going, as a representative of the decorative planting project group, to attend a meeting with the Assistant Director of Finance (ADF) and two councillor members of the Countryside & Horticulture Committee where they intend to explain their reasoning further and outline your new budget. Your team have asked you to strongly challenge the budget cut.

Review the following responses A to E and indicate which one you believe to be the response to the situation.

Responses:
(0/1 Points)

A. Send an email to the ADF and the two councillors before the meeting giving a reasoned and evidence-based argument for why the budget cut is not appropriate. Prepare this argument in a bullet-point sheet for you to refer to in the meeting. Include points about voter and visitor reactions to the urban landscape. ✓

B. Send a copy of "Encouraging Wildlife in Inner Cities" to each of the people with whom you will be meeting. It is a pamphlet that explains how roadside planting can encourage bats, birds and insects to thrive in the urban environment.

C. Call the Director of Finance and ask him to attend the meeting as you want to talk to the person with 'the final say'.

D. Ask for information from the Lokogoma Countryside & Wildlife Officer with regard to the impact that planting schemes have had on wildlife. Prepare a document outlining this information to take to the meeting.

E. Collate data on response to the planting schemes' from visitors and residents. Prepare an 'easy-to-digest' handout, for the ADF and the councillors, which outlines the key arguments for keeping the budget as it is. Hand copies of these out at the meeting.

15. You are currently working in the Parking Services department of LCC. You have just started work on a project to propose and plan the introduction of a new residents' parking scheme in West Central Lokogoma. In order to have the proposal approved and put out for public consultation it needs to be passed by the Parking Committee of the council. The project manager (PM) has just approached you and told you that this month's meeting of the Parking Committee has been brought forward by a week in order to work around a Bank Holiday later in the month. This means that the team need to complete the proposal by 4pm today. Your PM believes the proposal will require 15 person hours to write; it is now 10am and there are 2 of you available to work on the paper.

Review the following responses A to E and indicate which one you believe to be the response to the situation.

Responses:
(1/1 Points)

A. Split the paper into manageable chunks and prioritise these sections. Make sure that you and your colleague complete the high priority sections first and leave appendices etc. until last. At least that way you can submit appendices and supplementary information later if they aren't complete by 4pm.

B. Start writing the proposal immediately; work as hard as you can to get the entire paper written by 4pm.

C. Ask your Project Manager to consider submitting the proposal to next month's Committee meeting.

D. Prioritise the sections of the report and share the high priority ones between the two of you, leaving the less important appendices until last. Also email the Committee convener to see if there is any flexibility in the deadline. ✓

E. Ask your PM to check why the submission has to be done by 4pm today (you assume that no-one will be reading it overnight); ask for an extension to 9am tomorrow morning if at all possible.

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16. Lokogoma City Council is in the process of tendering for a new secondary waste management contract. Currently 'Wastewarriors' (a mid-size specialist recycling company) provide the domestic kitchen food waste collection & recycling service for LCC. Their contract is due to expire in 2 months' time and a new contract needs to be awarded for the service. The current provider is competing for the contract along with 2 other companies.

You are on a project team which is responsible for analysing and comparing the competing bids. The competing companies have all put in closely comparable bids with regard to the statutory criteria of cost and service reliability (i.e. how likely they are to collect the food waste on schedule). Therefore your Project Manager has asked you to devise a matrix of other possible selection criteria for the council to use to discriminate between the bidders.

Review the following responses A to D and indicate which one you believe to be the response to the situation.

Responses:
(0/1 Points)

A. Consult a range of sources (including other Local Authorities, waste management industry experts, expert websites and previous LoSCC bid processes) and collate a longlist of possible criteria to present to your PM for discussion. ✓

B. Brainstorm ideas yourself 'from first principles'.

C. Ask 'Wastewarriors' to suggest a list of additional selection criteria.

D. Ask for a meeting or phone call with the LCC Head of Waste Management and pick their brains as to what criteria might be appropriate.

E. Gather a few other team members together for a brainstorming session to generate as many possible criteria as you can. Check this list against the expert information on the internet to provide a realistic list for presentation to your PM.

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17. During your study day at Abuja University this week you got chatting to one of the other LCC Management trainees. His name is Garba Lawal and he started on the training scheme and the MSc at the same time as you. You know him reasonably well although you have never worked on the same project at LCC and only usually meet up on your study days.

Garba told you in confidence that he is struggling to cope with the demands of the MSc course work, revising for the end of year exams and the tight deadlines on a project at work. He tells you that he is thinking of dropping out of the LCC programme but finishing the MSc, although he will have to pay back all of his tuition fees which were covered by LCC.

Review the following responses A to D and indicate which one you believe to be the response to the situation.

Responses:
(0/1 Points)

A. Arrange a time next week for a sit down / lunch with Garba to talk through his problems in detail. Let him get all his problems 'off his chest' and then help him start to generate solutions to his time management challenges and ways that he can increase his personal resilience.

B. Take him out for a drink and help him forget about his troubles and unwind for at least one night.

C. Feel relieved that there will be one less person to compete with for LCC management jobs and wish him luck in the future.

D. Suggest Garba talks his problems through with his graduate mentor.

E. Suggest a time next week when you will be available for a longer chat with Garba. Bring along some time management / stress management books to show Garba. Listen to his problems in detail. ✓

Scenario 5

You are a customer advisor at the Nigerian contact centre for Greenwinds Energy. Greenwinds is a renewable-source electricity and gas supplier to European and African domestic and business customers. Your role is to answer inbound telephone calls and emails from customers in Nigeria, answering questions and queries about Greenwinds products and services and dealing with customer complaints and issues. You work in a team of 15 and you report into a Customer Service Team Leader.

Greenwinds has recently introduced a 'one-rate' policy for all its energy packages. Customers will be charged the same rate per unit of electricity or gas regardless of their method of payment or when their peak usage of energy is. This has many advantages including, greater clarity of charging, no encouragement for use of electrical appliances at night, which can be unsafe, and no discrimination against people using pre-pay meters, pre- pay cards or monthly cheque payment, all of whom are traditionally the less prosperous customers.

18. A customer has come through to you with a complaint about Greenwinds billing system. He is a new customer who has used the Greenwinds Dual Fuel electricity and gas product for a month. He says that he wasn't told by the doorstep sales person when he signed up that the electricity would not be split into off-peak and peak rate units. With his previous supplier he had been used to maximising his energy use at night in order to benefit from the cheaper rate electricity. He was under the impression that he would be able to continue to do this with Greenwinds and now he is very upset as he has realised, upon receiving his first bill, that this is not the case.

    Review the following responses A to D and indicate which one you believe to be the response to the situation.

    Responses:
    (1/1 Points)

    A. Apologise for the confusion but state that the Greenwinds charging policy is clearly written on the joining contract and on the website.

    B. Apologise for the confusion and ask the customer for more detail about the sales conversation, including the salesperson's name or description. Say that you will ask your manager to investigate the way that the contract was sold and to look at whether any miscommunication had happened on the doorstep. Say you will get back to the customer on a daily basis to keep him updated of progress. ✓

    C. Apologise for the confusion and offer the customer a goodwill waiver of one month's standing charge.

    D. Apologise for the confusion and say that you are sorry to hear that he is feeling upset and hope that Greenwinds excellent service and eco-friendly product will make up for the initial misunderstanding in the long-run

19. You have recently noticed that your fellow team member, Sandy, is raising his voice quite frequently at the customers and has terminated a few calls early when customers have been expressing dissatisfaction in a rude or discourteous way. Another colleague told you in confidence that Sandy has got problems at home, his wife recently lost her job, they are experiencing financial strain and it is taking its toll on their relationship. Sandy is worried that his wife is depressed and he is finding it hard to concentrate on work properly. You sit next to Sandy in the contact centre and you have noticed his behaviour becoming more erratic over the last few weeks.

Review the following responses A to D and indicate which one you believe to be the response to the situation.

Responses:
(1/1 Points)

A. Do nothing. It is not your responsibility to intervene with Sandy, it is up to the Customer Service Team Leader to respond if his work is suffering. You feel that Sandy would be upset and offended if you 'poked your nose in' with his personal problems.

B. Speak to Sandy and say that you want him to know that you are always available for a chat if he ever needs someone to talk to. Ask him if there is anything that you can do to help and support him at work as you have noticed him dealing with customers differently recently, not in his usual friendly, calm manner. ✓

C. Say to Sandy that you have noticed that his personal life is affecting his work and say that he had better watch out that the Team Leader doesn't give him a formal warning about the way he is dealing with customers.

D. Tell your Team Leader that you are worried about Sandy and that you know that he has some problems at home. Say to the Team Leader that you are happy to take on some of Sandy's workload whilst he is feeling stressed and under pressure.

20. Today is Monday. You had a team meeting this morning in which your Team Leader mentioned that Head Office was unhappy with current levels of customer satisfaction with the contact centre and that there has been a dip in service quality. She said that, therefore, she would be looking closely at the service quality report every week and is expecting an improvement. The way that the contact centre service quality is measured has recently been changed: a new customer satisfaction survey has been introduced which is emailed to customers. Mystery shoppers have also been employed to call at random and record the way that they are dealt with by contact centre staff.

Review the following responses A to D and indicate which one you believe to be the response to the situation.

Responses:
(1/1 Points)

A. Make an extra special effort to be warm, friendly and helpful to customers throughout the week.

B. Look at Greenwinds intranet 'service quality' site which outlines the new measurement methods in detail. Analyse the customer satisfaction questions and the mystery shopper criteria and change your behaviour, if necessary, to ensure that you are fulfilling these requirements.

C. Wait for a further briefing from your Team Leader. She usually sends a note round following the team meeting summarising what was said. You are hopeful that she will be more specific in this note as to what is required of you in order to improve the service quality ratings.

D. Ask for a quick chat with your Team Leader sometime today and find out from her what she feels will be the best way for you to contribute to the service quality targets. Make sure you are aware of the detail of the new customer satisfaction measure and the Mystery Shopper criteria before you talk to her. ✓

✗

21. You are working a 10am to 6pm shift today. You have just returned from your lunch break at 2pm and your colleague informs you that the IT system which allows access to customer account and billing information has crashed. IT support have said that they won't be able to fix the system until 4.30pm. Your normal rate of calls is 7 or 8 queries an hour. Your Team Leader has sent an email to the whole team asking you to carry on answering customer calls and deal with them as best you can until the system is fixed.

Review the following responses A to D and indicate which one you believe to be the response to the situation.

Responses:
(0/1 Points)

A. Calculate that you will probably receive about 20 calls over the next 2.5 hours and that some of these may be queries that you can deal with easily using the website or other resources. Resolve to take the details of the other customers and call them back between 4.30pm and 6pm. You may have to call some of them on the following day as 5pm onwards is peak evening call time and you will be busy with new calls. ✓

B. Go and see your Team Leader and ask her what she expects you to do with customers who need to respond to a billing or account query today, after all it's her responsibility to provide some leadership in this stressful situation. It's probably not realistic to call them all back after 4.30pm as that is the start of the peak evening call time and inbound calls will be going up to 9 or 10 calls an hour per advisor then.

C. Suggest to your Team Leader that when the system is back up and running after 4.30pm that one customer advisor could be allocated to getting back to all the afternoon customers who's queries were not resolved, whilst the other advisors deal with the new inbound calls.

D. Deal with the straightforward queries that come in but ask all other customers to call back after 4.30pm. It will be too difficult to schedule outbound calls when the evening peak begins.

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